

# Meeting Automation in the Middle: *Why NetOps automation can't wait*

**Tim Sando**

Sony Interactive Entertainment

**AUTROCON S**

**THE NETWORK AUTOMATION CONFERENCE**

# Incident to Insight

A maintenance check went  
from

**5 min** >>> **30 sec**

## Manual checks

login • parse •  
validate

## Link\_Check

repeatable link  
validation

## Consistency

same answer • same  
standard

**origin story**

Automating verification mattered more than automating the shortcut.

# Why not just wait?

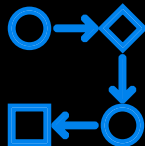
## BROAD AUTOMATION (LONG TERM)



Strategy



Platform



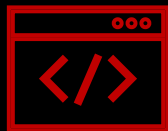
Orchestration



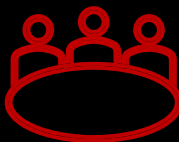
Future  
State



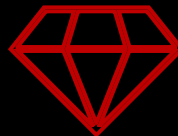
Daily  
Toil



Quick  
Tools



Team  
Impact



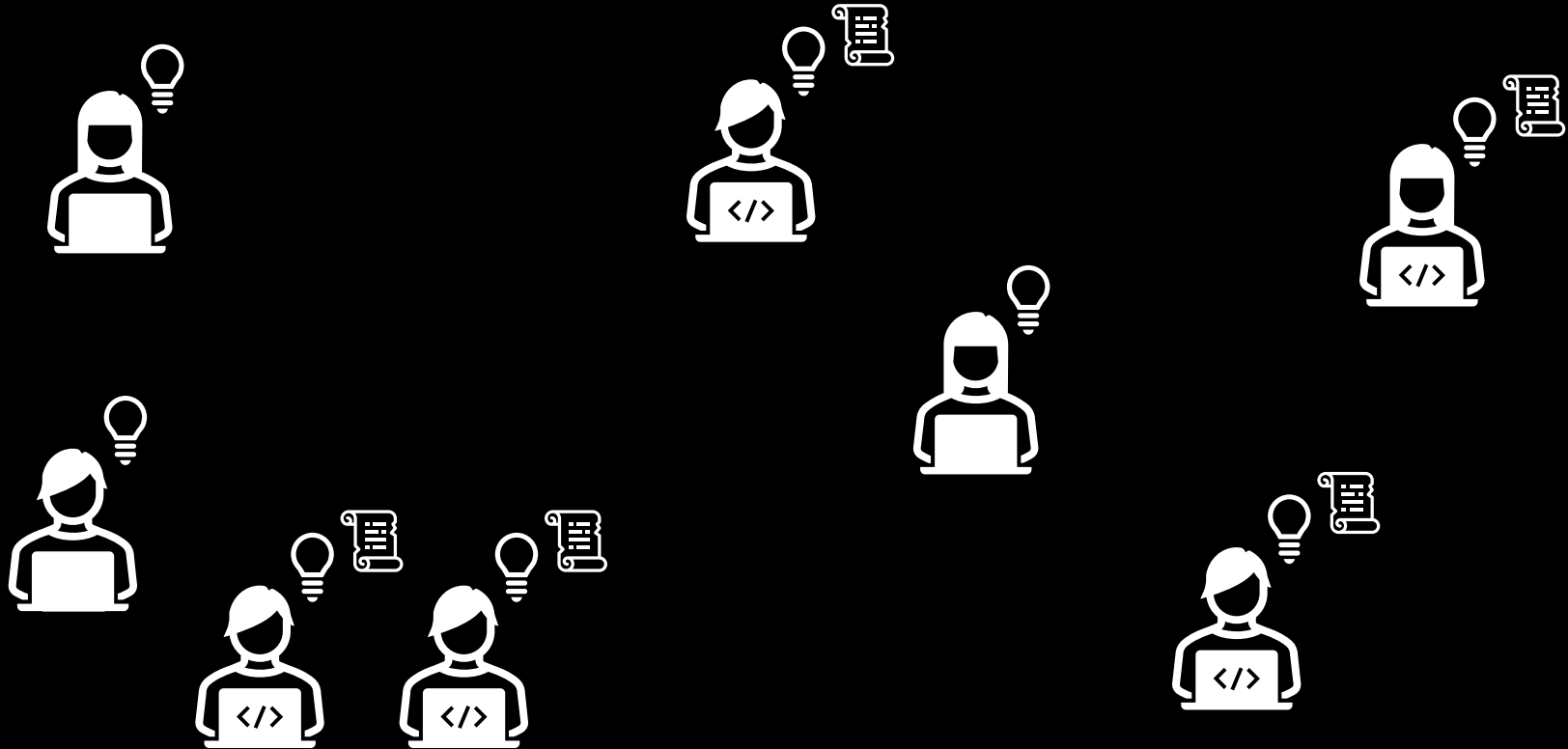
Immediate  
Value

## OPERATIONS AUTOMATION (TODAY)

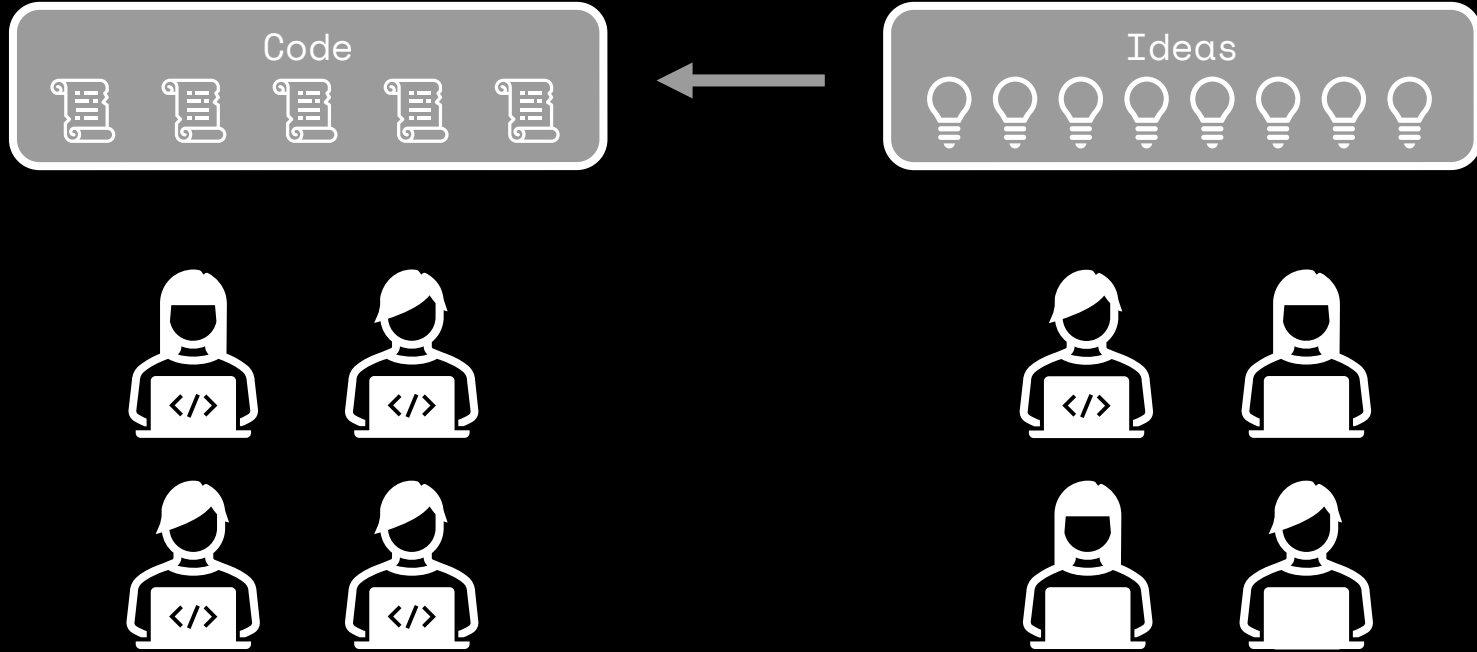


Meet in  
the  
middle

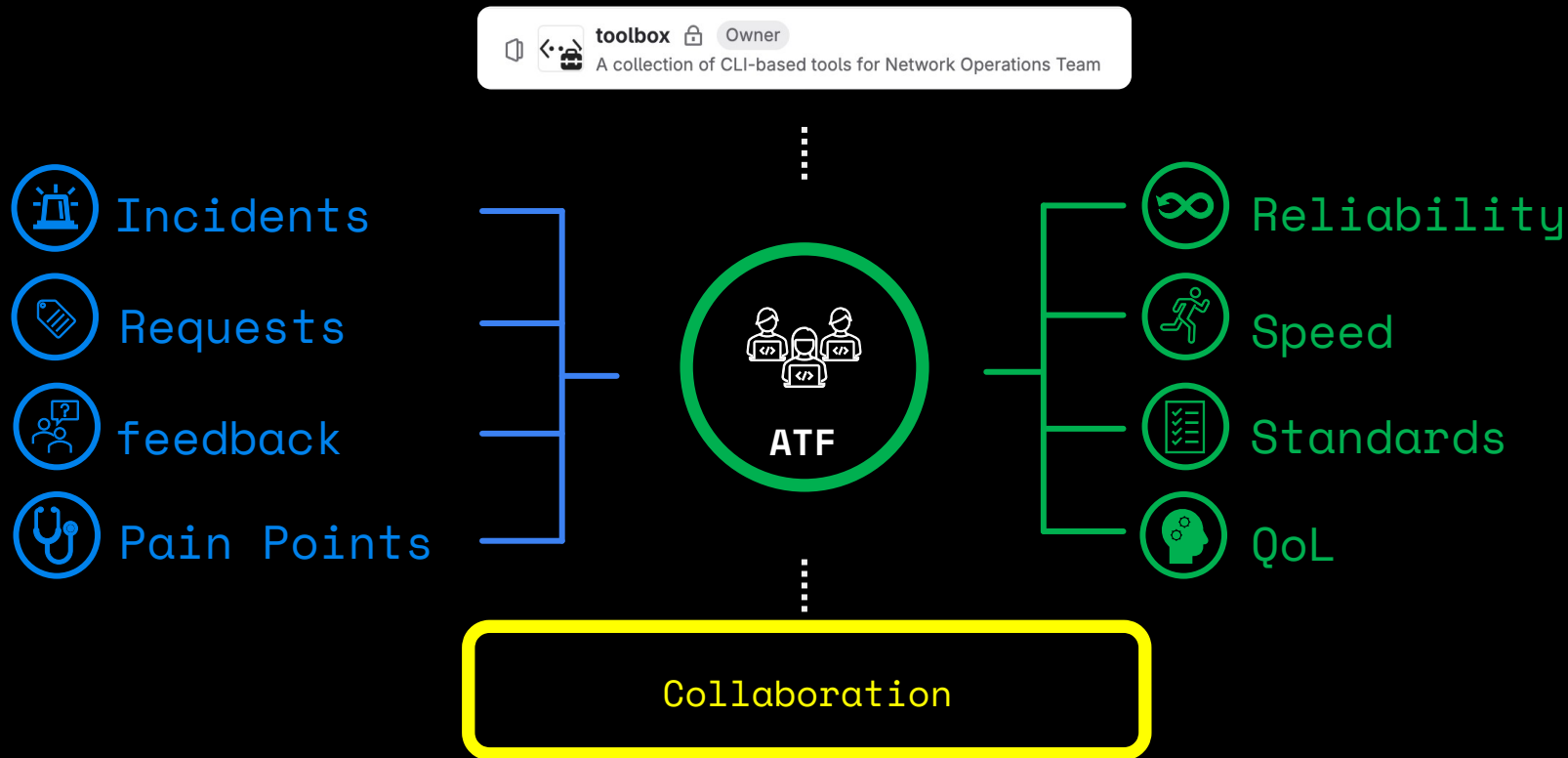
# Fast. Decentralised. Unstructured.



Fast. Decentralised. Unstructured.



# NetOps ToolBox and the ATF



Crawl, Walk, Run



# Crawl



## Start where the toil is.

The first job was not architecture.

It was proving that small tools could make a shift easier.

01

### Incident data

fewer tabs, faster  
context



02

### Task execution

repeat the boring  
parts safely



03

### Consistency

again, and again, and  
again

Manual runbooks become automation blueprints.



# Walk



Pay down the debt without stopping delivery.

## Before

monolith scripts  
hard-coded dependencies  
feature duplication  
“works on my laptop”



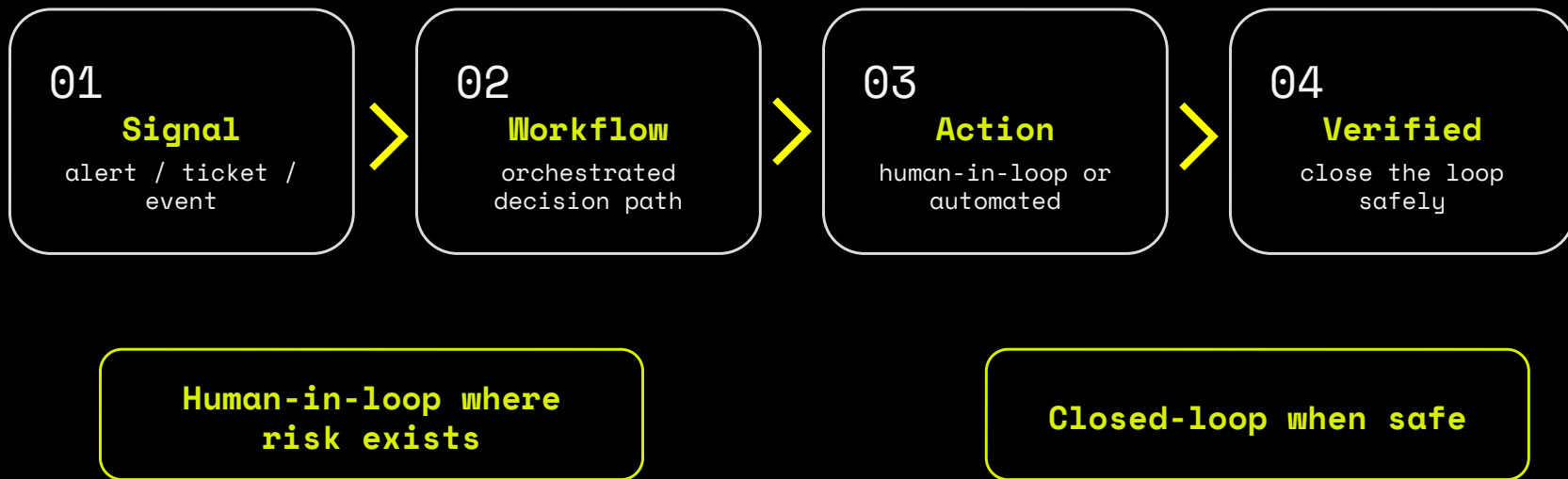
## After

Python package  
object oriented  
unit tests  
shared interfaces

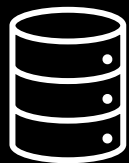
# Run



The tool moves from the operator's laptop to the workflow layer.



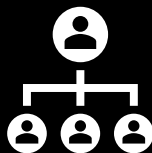
# Why were we successful?



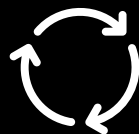
+



+



+



=



Data

Passion

Support

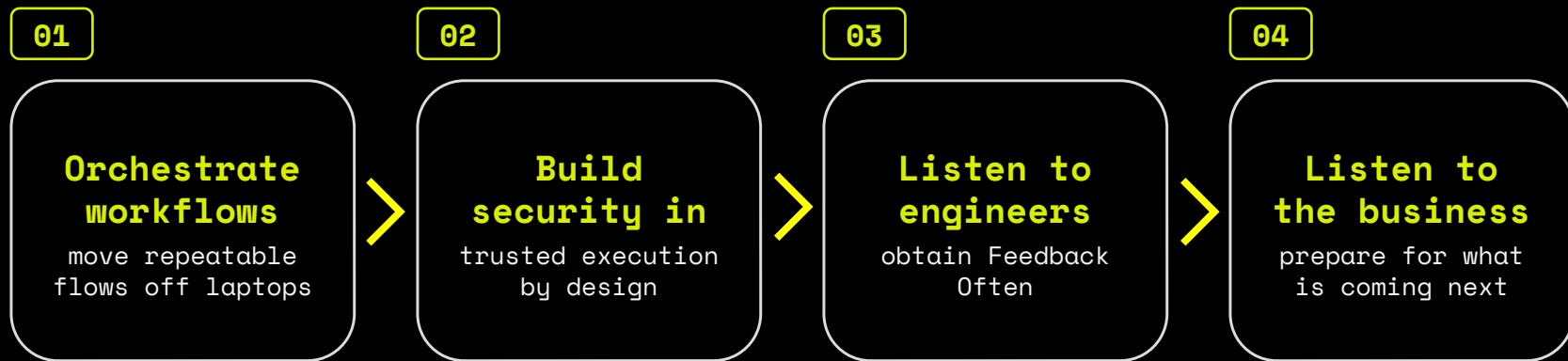
Feedback

Success!

# How we'll stay successful

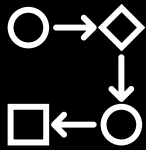


Adoption happens when the tool makes the shift easier.



Keep the platform scalable. Keep the work close to the operator.

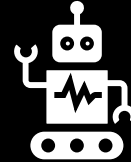
# Zooming out



Workflow  
Automation



Operator  
tooling



Closed-loop  
Automation

# Zooming out



Config  
Generation



Network  
Controllers



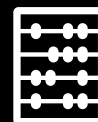
Internal  
API's



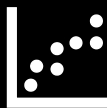
Network  
Resiliency



Forecasting



Budgeting &  
Contracts



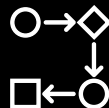
Metrics



Topology  
Mapping



Health



Workflow  
Automation



Operator  
tooling



Closed-loop  
Automation

# Lessons Learnt



## Start Small

Begin with problems that matter.

## Solve Problems

Focus on what is:

- Time Consuming
- Repetitive
- Important



## Seek Buy-In

Make it a formal part of the job.



## Foster Growth

Develop People, not just code.



# Meet Automation in the Middle: *NetOps automation can't wait!*







Questions?